

CCAR-F Cheat Sheet

AGENTIC ARCHITECTURE

27% OF EXAM

AgentsRoutingChainingParallelismSubagents

TOOLS + MCP

18% OF EXAM

SchemasToolsResourcesPromptsTransport

QUICK FACTS

CREDENTIAL
CCAR-F

ACCESS
Partner network

USERS
Claude architects

VERIFY
Exam portal

ISSUER
Anthropic

FOCUS
Production architecture

CORE
Claude ecosystem

CLAUDE CODE

20% OF EXAM

MemorySettingsPermissionsHooksCI

CONTEXT + RELIABILITY

15% OF EXAM

RAGCachingEvalsRetriesGuardrails

SIMPLE FIRST

AG

Call, retrieve, chain, route, agent.

CallRetrieveChainRouteAgent

WORKFLOW VS AGENT

AG

Workflow
Predictable sequence
Easier control

Agent
Dynamic path
Higher autonomy

Prefer simplest control

PROMPTS + OUTPUT

20% OF EXAM

SystemExamplesSchemasJSONStops

PATTERN PICKER

AG

Task is simple

→

Single call

Needs facts

→

RAG call

Steps known

→

Prompt chain

Input classes known

→

Router

Subtasks independent

→

Parallel calls

Steps unknown

→

Agent loop

Quality measurable

→

Evaluator optimizer

Risk high

→

Human review

ARCHITECTURE PATTERNS

AG

Single call

Best baseline

RAG call

Retrieve then answer

Prompt chain

Ordered model steps

Router

Classify then dispatch

Parallel

Independent subtasks

Orchestrator

Plan then delegate

Evaluator

Judge then improve

CLAUDE CODE

CO

CLAUDE.md

Project memory

settings.json

Local configuration

Permissions

Gate risky actions

Slash command

Reusable workflow

Hook

Run workflow action

Subagent

Specialized helper

Headless

Noninteractive run

STRUCTURED OUTPUT

PR

Schema

Constrain fields

Enum

Limit choices

Required

Prevent omissions

Type

Protect parsing

Stop sequence

End generation

Parser

Validate output

Repair

Retry invalid JSON

AGENT CONTROLS

AG

Loop limit

Bound tool cycles

Role scope

Narrow responsibility

Tool scope

Least privilege

State

Track decisions

Handoff

Define output contract

Escalation

Ask human

Trace

Log key steps

SCHEMA VS PROSE

PR

Schema

Machine parsed
Validated fields

Prose

Human read
Flexible wording

Parsing needs schema

TOOL SAFETY

TO

Name, schema, scope, auth, errors.

Name

Schema

Scope

Auth

Errors

TOOL VS RESOURCE

TO

Tool

Performs action

Needs arguments

Resource

Provides context

Read oriented

Action needs tool

PROMPT BASICS

PR

System

Durable constraints

Task

Goal and inputs

Criteria

Success definition

Examples

Show desired shape

Context

Relevant facts

Delimiters

Separate content

Refusal

Handle unsafe asks

MCP PRIMITIVES

TO

Tool

Callable action

Resource

Readable context

Prompt

Reusable template

Server

Expose capabilities

stdio

Local subprocess

HTTP

Remote service

Auth

Protect access

STDIO VS HTTP

TO

stdio

Local process

Developer workflow

HTTP

Remote service

Network access

Match deployment boundary

PRODUCTION READY

RE

Eval, retry, timeout, monitor, fallback.

Eval

Retry

Timeout

Monitor

Fallback

EVAL VS MONITOR

RE

Eval

Predeployment test

Known cases

Monitor

Production signal

Live outcomes

Use both

RELIABILITY PICKER

RE

Output must parse

→

Schema validation

Facts may change

→

Retrieve current
source

Latency matters

→

Smaller model

Cost matters

→

Cache prefix

Tool may fail

→

Structured error

Safety matters

→

Guardrails

Behavior drifts

→

Regression evals

Ambiguity remains

→

Ask user

CONTEXT + RETRIEVAL

RE

Context window

Token budget

Compression

Keep essentials

Retrieval

Fetch relevant facts

Chunking

Split documents

Citation

Expose provenance

Caching

Reuse static prefix

Freshness

Check current facts

PRODUCTION RELIABILITY

RE

Eval

Measure behavior

Golden set

Known examples

Regression

Catch drift

Retry

Handle transient
failure

Timeout

Bound latency

Fallback

Degrade gracefully

Monitor

Track outcomes

COMMON TRAPS

Overagenting

Simple call works $\neq$ Avoid needless loops

Broad Tools

Scope permissions $\neq$ Constrain inputs

Unparsed Output

Validate schemas $\neq$ Repair failures

Stale Context

Retrieve current facts $\neq$ Cite sources

No Evaluation

Define success $\neq$ Track regressions

LAST MINUTE

1. Start with baseline
2. Pick pattern deliberately
3. Scope tool access
4. Validate structured output
5. Handle tool errors
6. Budget context tokens
7. Add eval coverage
8. Plan fallback behavior



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